

Starting off this reflection I did want to state that I used Gen AI more than previous weeks. I really struggled with this week's homework, and the example code and other resources online just weren't working with what I was trying to do, and my schedule just doesn't permit a time I could meet with you to sit down and go through my homework.

I asked Gen AI to work through many of the concepts, and explain to me how things worked and how to implement them into my code. I especially struggled with the duplicate and shuffle function, so I did ask Gen AI to help me with that. First I looked at the code to try and understand how things were working on my own, then for the pieces I didn't quite get I asked the AI to help explain them to me.

I wanted to try and be as transparent about this assignment as possible. I feel kind of icky using AI as much as I did for this assignment... I tried to change and tweak the code to make it feel my own and understand it to the very best of my ability. Before I consulted Gen AI for any help with the homework I first tried to make my own rendition of the JS and CSS by referencing the course material and example site, but I couldn't get it to work. The base site and CSS are all done by me, which I feel good about, but something about this week just really didn't click for me, in terms of the JS.

Next week I'm going to really try and take the time to understand the concepts and find better troubleshooting resources. I do however feel like I learned a lot this week from using/looking at the Gen AI example site. I understand how you can create an empty array, add elements to it by iteration indexes with a for loop, and access the array through that index. I learned how to build a table with columns and rows, and how to add spacing between them through my own troubleshooting. I learned how to play with "id's" a little with this assignment and furthered my knowledge on updating the DOM and accessing site elements by the "get"

function. I did understand how to properly link the images and add the correct amount of them to the array. I enjoyed picking those out and styling my site. It's been almost four years since I took creative coding 1, so while some of this feels familiar I'm extremely out of practice and feel as though I am re-learning everything over again. Which is fine, but I do feel bad about constantly asking questions.

There were also many moments in my first iteration where I was trying to de-bug on my own. A big part of what I was having trouble with was getting my images for my tiles to display correctly. I did a lot of playing around, adjusting the JS to try and get my images to display, googled things, the like. Eventually I just decided it would be best to comment out what I had tried and start over with a new approach.

In this instance I didn't have any issues with the Gen AI being wrong. The only preference issues I had with what it generated for the assignment was that all the JS was located in the head tag of the HTML document, as well as the CSS. It provided a good simple example, just using placeholder images. Because of that simplicity though the code was really condensed, and a little hard to understand. It used things that we haven't gone over in class yet so while it was a good example, I wouldn't have taken much from it besides the base logic.